

Decode the Chart

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For each chart below, answer: What is it trying to tell you? Do you trust it? Why or why not?

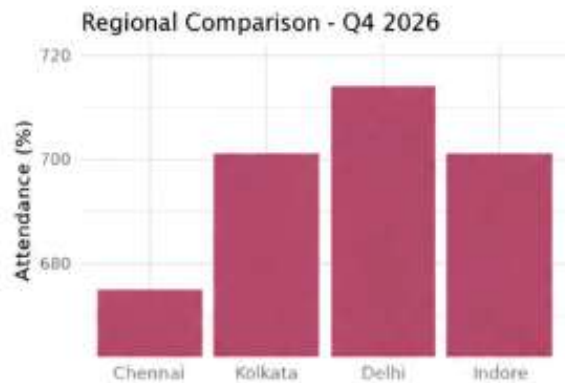


Chart 1

App Usage by Category (14 categories)



Chart 2

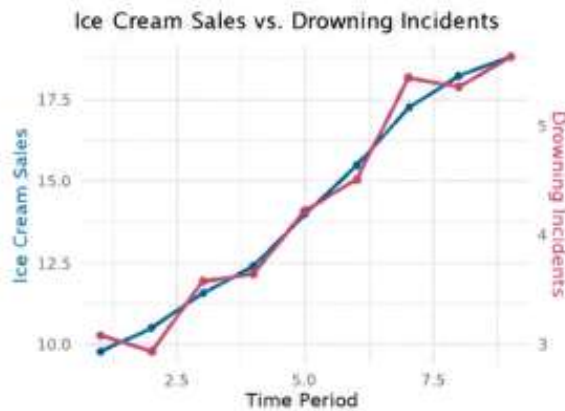


Chart 3



Chart 4

Your notes:

01-10-26

Activity - 1

chart 1 - Truncated Y-axis (bar chart)

The Y-axis starts at around 670 instead of 0, which makes the differences in attendance between Chennai, Kolkata, Delhi and Indore look much larger than they actually are. For example, the bars appear to have large differences but the actual values are relatively close.

Rule: Bar charts should normally start at zero because the bar length represents the value. A truncated axis can exaggerate visual difference.

chart 2 - Too many categories in a pie chart

The pie chart contains 14 categories, creating many small wedges that are difficult to compare accurately. Slices are especially hard to distinguish because we have to judge angles and colors.

Rule: Pie charts work best with a small number of categories.

chart 3 - Dual Y-axis and misleading correlation

The chart compares Pre-festival sales and drowning incidents using two different Y-axes. The two lines appear to move together, which may suggest a relationship, but the visual can be affected.

Rule: Be cautious with dual-axis charts. Prefer a shared scale.

Chart - 4 overplotting (scatter plot)

The scatter plot contains a very large number of points. Because many points overlap, dense area because difficult to distinguish and the overall distribution is harder to interpret.

Rule: for large datasets, use transparency (alpha), smaller points, a 2D histogram or contour line to make the distribution easier to see.